

Cat Aggression Health Signal Guide — Action Checklist

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RULE OUT MEDICAL CAUSES FIRST

- ☐ **Run Complete Pain Assessment:** Work through the full 15-item feline pain checklist, answering yes, no, or sometimes for each item to identify physical sources of your cat's aggression.
- ☐ **Schedule Same-Week Vet Visit:** Book a veterinary appointment within the same week if you answered "yes" to three or more items, especially when physical symptom clusters appear together.
- ☐ **Check for Urinary and GI Issues:** Look specifically for signs of urinary problems, gastrointestinal distress, or chronic pain if your "yes" answers cluster around items 8, 9, 10, 11, and 12 of the pain checklist.
- ☐ **Watch for Systemic Illness Signs:** Watch for signs of systemic illness or metabolic disruption if your "yes" answers center on items 1, 6, 7, 12, 13, and 15 of the pain checklist, which require veterinary diagnosis.

TRACK BEHAVIOR DAILY

- ☐ **Start 7-Day Elimination Log:** Begin a 7-day litter box and appetite log today, recording elimination frequency, consistency, and timing every morning and evening to build data for your vet.
- ☐ **Record Water and Food Intake:** Track changes in water intake, food consumption, and treat behavior alongside your cat's daily elimination patterns to spot subtle metabolic shifts early.
- ☐ **Document Hiding and Withdrawal:** Record when your cat retreats to isolated areas or unusual hiding spots throughout the day, noting frequency, duration, and any triggers you observe.
- ☐ **Track Responses to Touch and Approach:** Note whether your cat flinches, pulls away, or vocalizes when you touch her back, abdomen, legs, or face during normal daily interactions.

REINTRODUCE CATS SAFELY

- ☐ **Rule Out Pain Before Assuming Hormone Influence:** Complete the pain assessment checklist before concluding that human hormone changes or stress are driving your cat's behavioral shifts.
 - ☐ **Apply Gradual Reintroduction Protocol:** Start a slow reintroduction process for each cat showing aggression, beginning with scent swapping before allowing any visual contact between them.
 - ☐ **Observe Cat Behavior During Human Health Changes:** Watch whether your cat becomes unusually clingy, protective, or aggressive during pregnancy, illness, or medication adjustments in your household.
 - ☐ **Prepare Full Behavioral History for Vet:** Compile your pain assessment results and observation log into a complete picture to give your veterinarian actionable information for diagnosis.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.